The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Completely Purifying All Karmic Obscurations"

Ārya-sarvakarmāvaraṇaviśodhanī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 1009 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ལས་ཀྱི་སྒྲིབ་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་རྣམ་པར་སྦྱོང་བ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Completely Purifying All Karmic Obscurations, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarvakarmāvaraṇaviśodhanī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Le Kyi Dripa Tamche Nampar Jongwa Shyejawé Zung, is a brief incantation text centered on a single dhāraṇī-mantra. Opening with homage to the Tathāgata Akṣobhya, it presents the mantra and then explains its rite and benefits. Constant recitation is said to purify karma carried from life to life, and recitation three times a day to purify even the five acts of immediate retribution. A single recitation is said to dispel bad omens and nightmares, and the text also praises the protective power of wearing the written mantra on the body. It is Toh 1009 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts.

In Sanskrit: arya sarba karma ābaraṇa biśodhani nāma dhāraṇī
In Tibetan: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Completely Purifying All Karmic Obscurations."

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha Akṣobhya.

namo ratnatrayāya oṃ kaṃkani kaṃkani rocani rocani troṭani troṭani trāsani trāsani bratihana pratihana sarba karma baraṃ parāṇi me svāhā

This is the rite for this dhāraṇī-mantra. If one recites it constantly, all the karma carried on from one life to the next will be completely purified. If one recites it at the three times of day, even the five acts of immediate retribution will be purified. If one recites it once, bad omens, bad dreams and inauspicious things will disappear. If one wears it on the body, or writes it in a book and wears it at the neck, untimely death will never befall that person.

Whoever is moved by compassion may recite it into the ear of a wild animal, a bird, a human being or a nonhuman at the time of death, and that being will not go to the lower realms. Or, if someone has died and passed away, one should speak the name of the deceased. Then, if for that one's sake one recites it with loving-kindness and compassion a hundred, a thousand or a hundred thousand times, that being, even if already born in hell, will be liberated at once.

One should recite it over earth, sesame, white mustard seed or water, whichever is at hand, and scatter it on the body of the dead; or wash the body and then cremate it; or else place the remains inside a stupa. If one also writes out the vidyā-mantra and ties it to the head, then even one who has been born in the lower realms will without doubt be liberated within seven days and will be born in the world of the higher realms, the happy destinies, or else will be born according to the power of their own aspirations.

Suppose someone, at the time of the full moon, bathes and makes himself clean, changes his clothes at the three times of day, and either does not eat, or else eats only white foods, and, while circumambulating a stupa containing relics, recites it a hundred thousand times together with the name of the person concerned. That person will then be liberated from the lower realms and be born among the gods of the Pure Abodes. Coming before the practitioner, they will make offerings and show themselves, say "Excellent!", circumambulate three times, and vanish.

One should write that person's name and recite the dhāraṇī-mantra, make a hundred thousand stupas, honor them well with parasols, victory banners, pennants and the like, and then cast them into the great ocean or else into a river. That being will thereby be liberated from the hells and the other lower realms.

Or else, having made offerings in that way, one should at the end build a great stupa at a crossroads and honor it well with parasols, victory banners, pennants and the like. One should also invite the noble Saṅgha to a feast, present them with gifts and honor them well, and declare: "May this become a root of virtue for so-and-so! Through this alone may he be born in the world of the higher realms, the happy destinies!" That person will then be born exactly so, will show himself, say "Excellent!", and vanish.

Even someone who has committed the five acts of immediate retribution, or rejected the true Dharma, or disparaged the noble ones, will have all karmic obscurations exhausted merely by seeing this dhāraṇī written on a wall at the moment of death. What need, then, to speak of reading it aloud and reciting it? The Tathāgata Akṣobhya himself will come and say, "Son of noble family, come here to me!"

The noble dhāraṇī Completely Purifying All Karmic Obscurations is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "A hundred thousand stupas" refers to the small molded clay stupas customarily made in such rites, which are then deposited in water.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.